

◀ TEEMING KRILL

This krill swarm off the Pacific coast of California has attracted a school of hungry fish.



▲ KRILL

Antarctic krill look like shrimp but grow up to 2.4 in (6 cm) long.

KRILL SWARMS

Shrimplike krill are a lot larger than copepods. They live in all the world's oceans, but are most abundant in the cold Southern Ocean where they form vast swarms that turn the ocean red. Like copepods, they feed on microscopic life, but are in turn preyed upon by Antarctic whales, as well as many fish and penguins.

UP AND DOWN

Copepods and many other types of zooplankton sink into the twilight zone by day to hide from fish that hunt by sight. As night falls, they swim up to the surface again to feed on phytoplankton. But some fish such as these herring have evolved ways of catching copepods in the dark, and every night dense schools of herring gather at the ocean surface to feast on the swarms of small animals.



EGGS AND BABIES

Many marine animals such as fish, crabs, and clams produce eggs that drift in the sunlit zone. The eggs hatch as tiny larvae that feed on phytoplankton, just as copepods do. Eventually, the larvae turn into adults. Many of these animals settle on the seabed and never move far again. So this drifting stage of their life is the only way they can spread to different parts of the ocean.

